

Aviation English

Instructor guide for advanced ESL learners working in aviation

Audience: aviation operations managers, airline staff, maintenance coordinators, safety teams, dispatchers, airport operations staff, ground handlers, and aviation-adjacent professionals

Focus: An aviation English curriculum for safety culture, operations control, maintenance coordination, irregular operations, ground handling, compliance, passenger escalation, and incident reporting.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

Purpose and Course Logic

An aviation English curriculum for safety culture, operations control, maintenance coordination, irregular operations, ground handling, compliance, passenger escalation, and incident reporting.

Core language challenge

Advanced learners do not only need vocabulary. They need the ability to ask which standard applies, who owns the decision, what evidence is sufficient, what risk is being accepted, and how to disagree without sounding vague, defensive, or reckless.

Each module trains a realistic workplace pressure point with role-specific terms, decision language, pushback practice, and bounded decision activities learners can apply to their own work.

Course objectives

- Use aviation terminology accurately in meetings, written updates, handoffs, escalations, reviews, and client or stakeholder conversations.
- Turn vague requests into specific questions about evidence, owner, deadline, constraint, risk, and decision rights.
- Push back on unsafe, unsupported, noncompliant, unrealistic, or poorly scoped proposals while preserving professional trust.
- Handle realistic dialogues from the field, including conflict, uncertainty, documentation gaps, customer or stakeholder pressure, and cross-functional disagreement.
- Select language that produces concise workplace outputs: briefing notes, escalation updates, meeting scripts, risk memos, decision records, and follow-up messages.

Instructor Module Plans

Module 1. Safety Culture and Stop-Work Authority (90 minutes)

Use safety language that is direct and nonpunitive.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: safety management system, hazard, stop work, reporting culture.
- Explain the workplace tension: Safety, inspection, documentation, and operational control override schedule pressure.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Continue boarding to avoid delay.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a safety stop-work call.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

Ground staff notice a possible fuel leak during a turnaround.

Continue boarding to avoid delay.

Safety, inspection, documentation, and operational control override schedule pressure.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.

- Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a safety stop-work call.

Module 2. Operations Control and Dispatch Coordination (90 minutes)

Communicate operational constraints quickly and accurately.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: dispatch, crew legality, aircraft routing, delay code.
- Explain the workplace tension: Duty limits, passenger impact, aircraft routing, and recovery options need review.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Ask the crew to continue anyway.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a dispatch coordination update.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A crew legality issue appears before departure.

Ask the crew to continue anyway.

Duty limits, passenger impact, aircraft routing, and recovery options need review.

Classroom sequence

- Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
- Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
- Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
- Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a dispatch coordination update.

Module 3. Maintenance Deferrals and MEL Language (90 minutes)

Discuss maintenance status without casual reassurance.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: MEL, logbook, deferred maintenance, airworthiness.
- Explain the workplace tension: MEL conditions, logbook entry, placarding, and operational limitations must be confirmed.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Tell the gate it is fine.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a maintenance status brief.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A component issue may be deferrable.

Tell the gate it is fine.

MEL conditions, logbook entry, placarding, and operational limitations must be confirmed.

Classroom sequence

- Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
- Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.

3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a maintenance status brief.

Module 4. Irregular Operations and Passenger Communication (90 minutes)

Explain disruptions with empathy and operational accuracy.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: IROP, reaccommodation, misconnect, weather delay.
- Explain the workplace tension: Rebooking, hotel policy, crew, aircraft, and safety rationale need clear messaging.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Say flights are canceled due to weather and stop there.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a IROP passenger announcement.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

Weather causes cancellations across the network.

Say flights are canceled due to weather and stop there.

Rebooking, hotel policy, crew, aircraft, and safety rationale need clear messaging.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a IROP passenger announcement.

Module 5. Ground Handling and Turnaround Performance (90 minutes)

Coordinate fast turnarounds without unsafe shortcuts.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: turnaround, ground handling, load sheet, ramp safety.
- Explain the workplace tension: Fueling, catering, bags, security checks, and safety zones all have minimum requirements.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Cut corners to make the departure slot.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a turnaround risk update.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A late inbound aircraft has a short connection window.

Cut corners to make the departure slot.

Fueling, catering, bags, security checks, and safety zones all have minimum requirements.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a turnaround risk update.

Module 6. Security and Access Control (90 minutes)

Set boundaries around secure areas and credentials.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: secure area, badge, escort, audit.
- Explain the workplace tension: Access rules, escort requirements, identity checks, and audit risk apply.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Escort them informally because the work is urgent.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a access-control response.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A vendor arrives without proper badge access.

Escort them informally because the work is urgent.

Access rules, escort requirements, identity checks, and audit risk apply.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a access-control response.

Module 7. Incident Reporting and Investigation (90 minutes)

Report events factually before conclusions are known.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: incident report, damage assessment, root cause, corrective action.
- Explain the workplace tension: Damage assessment, reporting, evidence preservation, and accountability are required.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Describe it as minor and continue.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a incident report summary.

Customized scenario

Workplace pressure

A baggage vehicle clips aircraft equipment.

Describe it as minor and continue.

Damage assessment, reporting, evidence preservation, and accountability are required.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a incident report summary.

Module 8. Regulatory Audits and Readiness (90 minutes)

Answer audit questions with evidence, not confidence.

Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: audit, training record, compliance, corrective action.
- Explain the workplace tension: Records, currency, scope, and corrective action must be documented.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Say everyone is trained.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a audit response plan.

Customized scenario**Workplace pressure**

An auditor asks for training records for ground staff.

Say everyone is trained.

Records, currency, scope, and corrective action must be documented.

Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a audit response plan.

Nomenclature and Jargon

These are classroom working definitions. Learners should adapt wording to their organization's policies, systems, and local regulatory environment.

Safety Culture and Stop-Work Authority

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
safety management system	In aviation, safety management system is a performance or governance dimension that must be protected through defined evidence, thresholds, and accountability. Use it when teams need to use safety language that is direct and nonpunitive.	clarify safety management system; document safety management system	Contrast: safety management system should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify safety management system and the evidence that supports it.
hazard	In aviation, hazard is a condition or event that can create harm, loss, noncompliance, delay, or unacceptable performance. Use it when teams need to use safety language that is direct and nonpunitive.	assess hazard; mitigate hazard	Contrast: hazard identifies a possible or current exposure; it is not the same as accepting that exposure. Example: We need to assess hazard, name the owner, and agree on the trigger for escalation.
stop work	In aviation, stop work is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to use safety language that is direct and nonpunitive.	clarify stop work; document stop work	Contrast: stop work should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify stop work and the evidence that supports it.
reporting culture	In aviation, reporting culture is a workplace communication artifact that records facts, interpretation, and the decision or action requested. Use it when teams need to use safety language that is direct and nonpunitive.	prepare a reporting culture; circulate the reporting culture	Contrast: reporting culture is a reviewable communication artifact, not an undocumented verbal assurance. Example: The reporting culture should state the evidence, caveat, decision owner, and next action.

Operations Control and Dispatch Coordination

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
dispatch	In aviation, dispatch is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate operational constraints quickly and accurately.	clarify dispatch; document dispatch	Contrast: dispatch should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify dispatch and the evidence that supports it.
crew legality	In aviation, crew legality is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate operational constraints quickly and accurately.	clarify crew legality; document crew legality	Contrast: crew legality should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify crew legality and the evidence that supports it.
aircraft routing	In aviation, aircraft routing is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate operational constraints quickly and accurately.	clarify aircraft routing; document aircraft routing	Contrast: aircraft routing should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify aircraft routing and the evidence that supports it.
delay code	In aviation, delay code is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate operational constraints quickly and accurately.	clarify delay code; document delay code	Contrast: delay code should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify delay code and the evidence that supports it.

Maintenance Deferrals and MEL Language

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
MEL	Minimum equipment list identifying aircraft equipment that may be inoperative under specified conditions while the aircraft remains dispatchable.	clarify MEL; document MEL	Contrast: MEL should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify MEL and the evidence that supports it.
logbook	In aviation, logbook is information that can be checked to support a claim, decision, investigation, or compliance conclusion. Use it when teams need to discuss maintenance status without casual reassurance.	clarify logbook; document logbook	Contrast: logbook should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify logbook and the evidence that supports it.
deferred maintenance	In aviation, deferred maintenance is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss maintenance status without casual reassurance.	clarify deferred maintenance; document deferred maintenance	Contrast: deferred maintenance should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify deferred maintenance and the evidence that supports it.
airworthiness	Condition in which an aircraft conforms to approved design and is safe for operation under applicable rules.	confirm airworthiness; restore airworthiness	Contrast: Airworthiness is an aircraft's approved and safe operating condition, not simply whether the aircraft can physically depart. Example: Maintenance must confirm airworthiness before dispatch releases the aircraft.

Irregular Operations and Passenger Communication

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
IROP	In aviation, IROP is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain disruptions with empathy and operational accuracy.	clarify IROP; document IROP	Contrast: IROP should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify IROP and the evidence that supports it.
reaccommodation	In aviation, reaccommodation is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain disruptions with empathy and operational accuracy.	clarify reaccommodation; document reaccommodation	Contrast: reaccommodation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify reaccommodation and the evidence that supports it.
misconnect	In aviation, misconnect is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain disruptions with empathy and operational accuracy.	clarify misconnect; document misconnect	Contrast: misconnect should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify misconnect and the evidence that supports it.
weather delay	In aviation, weather delay is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain disruptions with empathy and operational accuracy.	clarify weather delay; document weather delay	Contrast: weather delay should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify weather delay and the evidence that supports it.

Ground Handling and Turnaround Performance

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
turnaround	In aviation, turnaround is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to coordinate fast turnarounds without unsafe shortcuts.	clarify turnaround; document turnaround	Contrast: turnaround should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify turnaround and the evidence that supports it.
ground handling	In aviation, ground handling is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to coordinate fast turnarounds without unsafe shortcuts.	clarify ground handling; document ground handling	Contrast: ground handling should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify ground handling and the evidence that supports it.
load sheet	In aviation, load sheet is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to coordinate fast turnarounds without unsafe shortcuts.	clarify load sheet; document load sheet	Contrast: load sheet should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify load sheet and the evidence that supports it.
ramp safety	In aviation, ramp safety is a performance or governance dimension that must be protected through defined evidence, thresholds, and accountability. Use it when teams need to coordinate fast turnarounds without unsafe shortcuts.	clarify ramp safety; document ramp safety	Contrast: ramp safety should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify ramp safety and the evidence that supports it.

Security and Access Control

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
secure area	In aviation, secure area is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to set boundaries around secure areas and credentials.	clarify secure area; document secure area	Contrast: secure area should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify secure area and the evidence that supports it.
badge	In aviation, badge is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to set boundaries around secure areas and credentials.	clarify badge; document badge	Contrast: badge should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify badge and the evidence that supports it.
escort	In aviation, escort is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to set boundaries around secure areas and credentials.	clarify escort; document escort	Contrast: escort should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify escort and the evidence that supports it.
audit	In aviation, audit is a structured examination of evidence, process, or results used to reach a defensible conclusion. Use it when teams need to set boundaries around secure areas and credentials.	conduct a audit; document the audit	Contrast: audit is a structured examination of evidence; it is not a conclusion reached before the evidence is checked. Example: The team will conduct a audit before it recommends a corrective action.

Incident Reporting and Investigation

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
incident report	In aviation, incident report is a workplace communication artifact that records facts, interpretation, and the decision or action requested. Use it when teams need to report events factually before conclusions are known.	assess incident report; mitigate incident report	Contrast: incident report identifies a possible or current exposure; it is not the same as accepting that exposure. Example: We need to assess incident report, name the owner, and agree on the trigger for escalation.
damage assessment	In aviation, damage assessment is a structured examination of evidence, process, or results used to reach a defensible conclusion. Use it when teams need to report events factually before conclusions are known.	conduct a damage assessment; document the damage assessment	Contrast: damage assessment is a structured examination of evidence; it is not a conclusion reached before the evidence is checked. Example: The team will conduct a damage assessment before it recommends a corrective action.
root cause	Underlying reason a problem occurred, not merely the visible symptom.	clarify root cause; document root cause	Contrast: root cause should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify root cause and the evidence that supports it.
corrective action	Action taken to fix a current problem and prevent recurrence.	clarify corrective action; document corrective action	Contrast: corrective action should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify corrective action and the evidence that supports it.

Regulatory Audits and Readiness

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
audit	In aviation, audit is a structured examination of evidence, process, or results used to reach a defensible conclusion. Use it when teams need to answer audit questions with evidence, not confidence.	conduct a audit; document the audit	Contrast: audit is a structured examination of evidence; it is not a conclusion reached before the evidence is checked. Example: The team will conduct a audit before it recommends a corrective action.
training record	In aviation, training record is information that can be checked to support a claim, decision, investigation, or compliance conclusion. Use it when teams need to answer audit questions with evidence, not confidence.	clarify training record; document training record	Contrast: training record should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify training record and the evidence that supports it.
compliance	Conformance with laws, regulations, standards, policies, contracts, or approved procedures.	clarify compliance; document compliance	Contrast: compliance should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify compliance and the evidence that supports it.
corrective action	Action taken to fix a current problem and prevent recurrence.	clarify corrective action; document corrective action	Contrast: corrective action should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify corrective action and the evidence that supports it.

Industry-Specific Meeting Moves

Situation	Useful language
Safety Culture and Stop-Work Authority	Before we commit, I want to confirm safety management system, hazard, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If safety, inspection, documentation, and operational control override schedule pressure., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Operations Control and Dispatch Coordination	Before we commit, I want to confirm dispatch, crew legality, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If duty limits, passenger impact, aircraft routing, and recovery options need review., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Maintenance Deferrals and MEL Language	Before we commit, I want to confirm MEL, logbook, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If mel conditions, logbook entry, placarding, and operational limitations must be confirmed., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Irregular Operations and Passenger Communication	Before we commit, I want to confirm IROP, reaccommodation, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If rebooking, hotel policy, crew, aircraft, and safety rationale need clear messaging., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Ground Handling and Turnaround Performance	Before we commit, I want to confirm turnaround, ground handling, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If fueling, catering, bags, security checks, and safety zones all have minimum requirements., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Security and Access Control	Before we commit, I want to confirm secure area, badge, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If access rules, escort requirements, identity checks, and audit risk apply., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Incident Reporting and Investigation	Before we commit, I want to confirm incident report, damage assessment, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If damage assessment, reporting, evidence preservation, and accountability are required., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Regulatory Audits and Readiness	Before we commit, I want to confirm audit, training record, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If records, currency, scope, and corrective action must be documented., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.

High-pressure pushback frames

- I understand the urgency. The risk is that we move faster than the evidence or process supports.
- I am not blocking the goal. I am naming the condition we need before the decision is safe and credible.
- If we accept this risk, we should name the owner, document the assumption, and define the trigger for escalation.
- That may be possible, but not under the current scope, timeline, or approval path.
- Let's separate what we know, what we assume, and what still needs confirmation.

Assessment and Coaching

Performance rubric

Skill	Developing	Proficient	Strong
Terminology	Recognizes terms but uses them loosely.	Uses field terms accurately in context.	Defines terms, connects them to evidence, and explains decision impact.
Pushback	Disagrees vaguely or avoids disagreement.	Names concern with evidence and next step.	Balances urgency, relationship, risk, owner, and decision rights.
Scenario judgment	Focuses on one stakeholder's preference.	Identifies constraint, risk, and process.	Guides the group toward a documented, realistic decision.
Decision communication	Selects language without linking it to the decision.	Chooses language that names facts, owner, and next step.	Distinguishes evidence, tradeoff, authority, and escalation in a decision-ready response.

Source orientation

- Current FAA, airport, carrier, and local aviation procedures.
- Company safety management system and reporting processes.
- Maintenance, ground-handling, and security manuals.
- The learner's own company policies, SOPs, contracts, systems, templates, and approved communication standards.